

WEEKLY MARKETS SUMMARY

Week of August 10–14, 2026

Global Markets Analysis · Nomad Capital · August 2026

WTI CRUDE OIL —
WEEKLY CHG.**+6.79%**

\$77.16 → \$82.40 · no Hormuz deal

ATLANTA FED GDPNOW —
Q3 2026**4.3%**

Down from 5.8% on 8/6 · weak retail sales

ARGENTINA EMBI —
WEEKLY CHG.**+21 bps**

Close 8/13*: 472 bps

MERVAL (ARS) —
WEEKLY CHG.**-4.52%**

3,086,785 → 2,947,349 pts

A week of two diverging stories. In the U.S., inflation kept cooling on every front —July CPI in line with consensus (+0.1% monthly, 3.4% year-over-year) and PPI coming in below expectations (0% monthly, 4.7% year-over-year)— but the close of the week brought a negative surprise of a different kind: July retail sales fell 0.6% month-over-month, the sharpest drop since May 2025, and the University of Michigan's consumer sentiment index sank nearly 8%. The Atlanta Fed's GDPNow model, which had touched 6.2% for the third quarter earlier in the month, collapsed to 4.3% by Friday. Wall Street still closed with modest gains, supported by the read that the Fed now has more room to skip a September hike. Oil stayed firm on the stalemate in the Strait of Hormuz negotiations, and the yen was back in the headlines over tension between Washington and Tokyo on the Bank of Japan's policy path. In Argentina, the week was negative from start to finish: country risk touched a two-month high, the Merval sold off sharply, and focus shifted to the Treasury's upcoming auction and the institutional durability of the newly announced Central Bank reform.

1. Timeline of the Week

WEEKLY TIMELINE

Mon 8/10

U.S. futures open the week mixed, with the Dow the weakest reference, while the VIX closes at its highest recent level and the dollar firms against most peers. Oil and industrial metals extend last week's gains. The Strait of Hormuz remains stuck: Iran keeps conditioning its reopening on economic compensation and the lifting of U.S. sanctions. It's a data-heavy week ahead: CPI on Wednesday, PPI on Thursday, and retail sales on Friday will determine whether the Fed rate-cut narrative stays intact. TSMC surprises with July sales up 45% year-over-year. Argentina's EMBI closes the prior Friday at 451 bps.

Tue 8/11

A defensive tone in global equities, with Europe retreating and Wall Street lacking clear direction, in a session where long-end yields rise alongside oil. Trump reopens his clash with Fed Governor Cook, while Warsh avoids committing to a monetary policy framework. Oil rises more than 2% as Iran-Oman talks stall. Nvidia and seven Wall Street banks assemble a \$500 billion financing vehicle for AI computing infrastructure. In Argentina, country risk rebounds sharply to 465 bps on deteriorating social sentiment and electoral uncertainty.

Wed 8/12

July CPI confirms disinflation: up just 0.1% month-over-month and 3.4% year-over-year, in line with consensus; core CPI rises 0.2% monthly. The market trims the odds of a September rate hike to 42%. Oil approaches \$90 a barrel as the International Energy Agency cuts its global supply forecast. A magnitude-7.4 earthquake strikes Colombia, paralyzing coffee exports. The Bessent-Takaichi dispute over the Bank of Japan's policy path threatens the joint yen rescue. Argentina's country risk touches 466 bps, a two-month high, with attention on the Treasury's upcoming auction.

Thu 8/13

July PPI surprises to the downside: flat month-over-month (vs. +0.2% expected) and its annual rate eases to 4.7% from 5.5%, reinforcing the disinflation narrative that followed the prior day's CPI. Argentina's country risk keeps climbing and closes at 472 bps.

Fri 8/14

July retail sales surprise with a 0.6% month-over-month drop —the sharpest since May 2025— against a consensus estimate of +0.4%; excluding autos and gas, the decline is 0.2%. The University of Michigan's consumer sentiment index falls nearly 8%, snapping a two-month streak of improvement. The Atlanta Fed's GDPNow model for the third quarter collapses to 4.3% from 5.8% just eight days earlier, dragged down by downward revisions to consumption and private investment. The market reads the combination of soft data as confirmation that the Fed won't hike in September. In Argentina, country risk holds above 470 bps and the Merval deepens its weekly decline.

2. Weekly Asset Price Changes

Prior close: Friday 8/7. Reference close: Friday 8/14.

Asset	Close Fri 8/7	Close Fri 8/14	Weekly chg.
S&P 500	7,757.64	7,785.76	+0.36%
Nasdaq 100	29,748.14	30,046.14	+1.00%
Dow Jones	54,036.93	53,732.41	-0.56%
VIX	14.90	14.25	-4.36%
10-Yr UST	~4.65%	4.70%	+5 bps
WTI (spot)	\$77.16	\$82.40	+6.79%
Gold (spot)	\$4,400.00	\$4,432.00	+0.73%
Bitcoin	\$64,928.32	\$62,834.10	-3.23%
EMBI Global (Argentina)	451 bps	472 bps*	+21 bps

Argentina local market	Close Fri 8/7	Close Fri 8/14	Weekly chg.
GD30D	\$0.5827	\$0.5801	-0.45%
GD35D	\$0.8143	\$0.8089	-0.66%
S&P Merval (ARS)	3,086,784.54	2,947,349.25	-4.52%
S&P Merval (USD MEP)	2,031.73	1,945.96	-4.22%
USD MEP (AL30)	\$1,519.29	\$1,514.60	-0.31%

* Argentina's EMBI reflects the last confirmed official close (Thursday 8/13); JP Morgan publishes with a lag. On Friday 8/14 the index held above 470 bps per market sources, with no exact closing figure available at the time of this report.

3. Key Drivers of the Week

KEY DRIVERS

Disinflation confirmed on two fronts, but consumption starts to show cracks

July's CPI (+0.1% monthly, 3.4% year-over-year) and PPI (0% monthly, 4.7% year-over-year) both surprised in the same direction: cooler-than-expected prices, reinforcing the idea that the energy-driven inflationary shock tied to the Middle East conflict is starting to fade. But the close of the week told a different story: July retail sales fell 0.6% month-over-month, the sharpest drop in more than a year, and the University of Michigan's consumer sentiment index sank nearly 8%. The same week that should have been unambiguously favorable for risk assets ended up introducing the first serious doubt about the strength of the U.S. consumer.

GDPNow collapses in just eight days

The Atlanta Fed's real-time growth estimate for third-quarter GDP had touched 6.2% on August 3; by Friday 8/14 it had fallen to 4.3%, with the nowcast for real personal consumption dropping from 4.1% to 2.5% and private investment from 17.9% to 15.2%. It's an abrupt correction that coincides in timing with the weak retail sales print, and one likely to keep getting revised as more August data comes in.

Oil finds no ceiling as Hormuz remains without a deal

WTI rose 6.79% for the week and approached \$90 a barrel, with the International Energy Agency cutting its global supply forecast. Iran continues to condition the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz on economic compensation and the lifting of U.S. sanctions, with no concrete agreement in sight. The pattern from the prior two weeks —announcements of an imminent deal that never materialized— appears to have given way to a more prolonged standoff.

Bessent-Takaichi tension over the Bank of Japan threatens the yen rescue

The dispute between the U.S. Treasury Secretary and the Japanese Prime Minister over the pace of Bank of Japan rate hikes puts at risk the sustainability of the joint intervention that had managed to support the yen in prior weeks. Without consensus on the direction of Japanese monetary policy, the market is starting to doubt whether the currency rescue has a firm floor.

Argentina's country risk touches a two-month high

Argentina's EMBI rose 21 basis points for the week to 472 bps, its highest level since early June, with focus on the Treasury's upcoming auction and the institutional durability of the newly announced Central Bank charter reform —the 2010 Redrado departure is cited as a cautionary precedent. The Merval tracked the decline with a weekly pullback of 4.52% in pesos and 4.22% in MEP dollars, decoupling from Wall Street's relatively steady tone.

4. Signals to Watch — Week of August 17–21

SIGNALS TO WATCH

Next GDPNow update (8/18)

After Friday's sharp downward revision, Tuesday's update will be key to confirming whether the consumption slowdown is taking hold or was a one-off reading based on still-incomplete quarterly data.

Argentina's Treasury auction

With country risk at a two-month high and the Central Bank reform still lacking legislative traction, the outcome of the next auction will be the first concrete test of whether the market remains willing to refinance peso maturities at reasonable rates.

Evolution of the Bessent-Takaichi tension over the BOJ

Without a resolution to this dispute, the sustainability of the joint intervention supporting the yen remains in question. The market will watch closely for any sign that Japan acts unilaterally or that Washington softens its pressure.

Strait of Hormuz: genuine negotiation or a prolonged new impasse?

With Iran maintaining its conditions (economic compensation and an end to sanctions) and no deal in sight, the market will need to determine whether oil holds on to its current geopolitical premium or whether the conflict enters a medium-term stalemate.

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